

Daily Bible Note

Date: September 24, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 14:1-17

1 Now Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David, and cedar trees, with masons and carpenters, to build him a house.

2 So David knew that the LORD had established him as king over Israel, for his kingdom was highly exalted for the sake of His people Israel.

3 Then David took more wives in Jerusalem, and David begot more sons and daughters.

4 And these are the names of his children whom he had in Jerusalem: Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon,

5 Ibhar, Elishua, Elpelet,

6 Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia,

7 Elishama, Beeliada, and Eliphelet.

8 Now when the Philistines heard that David had been anointed king over all Israel, all the Philistines went up to search for David. And David heard of it and went out against them.

9 Then the Philistines went and made a raid on the Valley of Rephaim.

10 And David inquired of God, saying, "Shall I go up against the Philistines? Will You deliver them into my hand?" The LORD said to him, "Go up, for I will deliver them into your hand."

11 So they went up to Baal Perazim, and David defeated them there. Then David said, "God has broken through my enemies by my hand like a breakthrough of water." Therefore they called the name of that place Baal Perazim.

12 And when they left their gods there, David gave a commandment, and they were burned with fire.

13 Then the Philistines once again made a raid on the valley.

14 Therefore David inquired again of God, and God said to him, "You shall not go up after them; circle around them, and come upon them in front of the mulberry trees.

15 And it shall be, when you hear a sound of marching in the tops of the mulberry trees, then you shall go out to battle, for God has gone out before you to strike the camp of the Philistines."

16 So David did as God commanded him, and they drove back the army of the Philistines from Gibeon as far as Gezer.

17 Then the fame of David went out into all lands, and the LORD brought the fear of him upon all nations.

II. Key Summary

- Hiram king of Tyre sent cedar trees and craftsmen to build David a house, and David knew that the LORD had established him as king over Israel, for the sake of His people Israel (v1-2). David took more wives in Jerusalem and had more children, and their names are listed (v3-7).
 - When the Philistines heard David had been anointed king, they came to search for him and raided the Valley of Rephaim. David inquired of God, and God said, "Go up." David defeated them at Baal Perazim, saying, "God has broken through my enemies by my hand like a breakthrough of water," and burned the gods the Philistines left behind (v8-12).
 - The Philistines raided again, and David inquired of God again. This time God said, "You shall not go up after them; circle around them," and go out to battle at the sound of marching in the mulberry trees. David did as God commanded, drove the Philistines from Gibeon to Gezer, and his fame went out into all lands (v13-17).
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III. Passage Analysis

Won Once, Still Asked Again

After the first victory over the Philistines, David was wise enough to wait on the LORD before the second battle. It is easy for many in the same situation to say, "I've fought this battle before. I know how to win." [1]

David won the first battle by going straight up (v10-11). When the Philistines came back, he didn't just repeat the same plan; he "inquired again of God" (v14). And God gave him a completely different plan: "You shall not go up after them; circle around them."

God Goes First

Let the sound of the going in the tops of the mulberry trees direct us to attend God's motions... When we perceive God to go before us let us gird up our loins, gird on our armour, and follow him. [2]

God told David, "God has gone out before you to strike the camp of the Philistines" (v15). God went out to fight first; David's part was to go when he heard the sound, doing "as God commanded him" (v16).

IV. Reflection Question

When the Philistines came a second time, David "inquired again of God." Think of something you've recently faced for the second time (another test, another fight with the same person). How did you decide what to do this time?

David asked God again, and God told him, "God has gone out before you" (v15). The victory was one God went out and fought first; David just had to follow.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Commentary on 1 Chronicles 14,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-14/>

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Concise Commentary (1 Chronicles 14),
https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/1Ch/1Ch_014.cfm